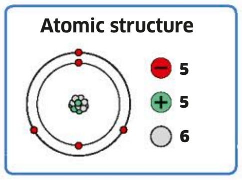
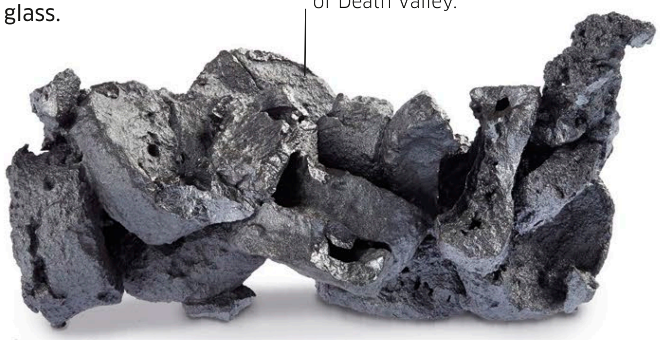
BORON
Boron
Discovered: 1808

A hard element, boron gets even harder when combined with carbon as boron carbide. This is one of the toughest materials known, used in tank armor and bulletproof vests. Boron compounds are used to make heat-resistant glass.



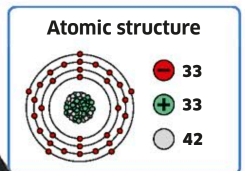
5 10.811
B
BORON



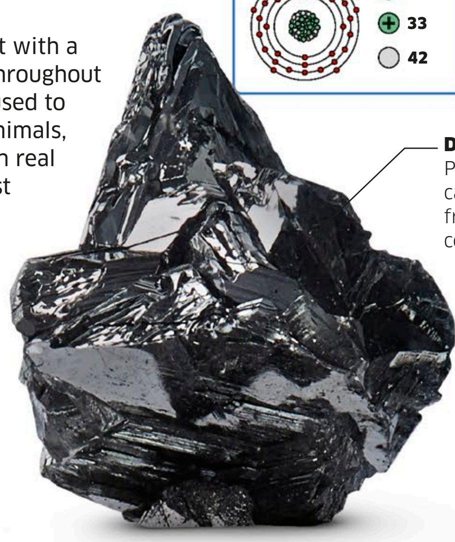
Dark and twisted
Pure boron is extracted from minerals in the deserts of Death Valley.

ARSENIC
Arsenicum
Discovered: 1250

Arsenic is an element with a deadly reputation. Throughout history, it has been used to poison people and animals, in fiction as well as in real life. Oddly, in the past it has been used as a medicine, too. It is sometimes used in alloys to strengthen lead, a soft, poisonous metal.



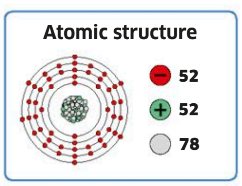
33 74.922
As
ARSENIC



Dark matter
Pure arsenic can be refined from mineral compounds.

TELLURIUM
Tellurium
Discovered: 1783

A rare element, in nature tellurium exists in compounds with other elements. It has a few specialist uses. It is used in alloys to make metal combinations easier to work with. It is mixed with lead to increase its hardness, and help to prevent it being damaged by acids. In rubber manufacture, it is added to make rubber objects more durable.

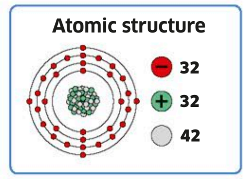


52 127.60
Te
TELLURIUM

Refined tellurium
Silvery crystals of tellurium are often refined from by-products of copper mining.

GERMANIUM
Germanium
Discovered: 1886

In the history of the periodic table, germanium is an important element. In 1869, in his first table, Mendeleev predicted that there would be an element to fill a gap below silicon. It was discovered 17 years later, and did indeed fit there. Today germanium is used together with silicon in computer chips.

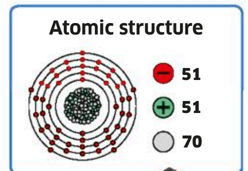


32 72.64
Ge
GERMANIUM

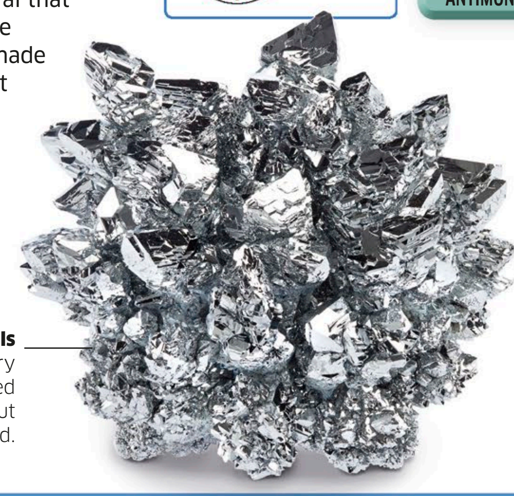
Pure germanium
Refined germanium is shiny but brittle.

ANTIMONY
Stibium
Discovered: 1600 BCE

Antimony comes from stibnite, a naturally occurring mineral that also contains sulfur. Stibnite used to be ground up and made into eye makeup by ancient civilizations, as seen on Egyptian scrolls and death masks. Known as kohl, its Arabic name, it is still used in cosmetics in some parts of the world.



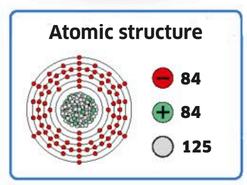
51 121.76
Sb
ANTIMONY



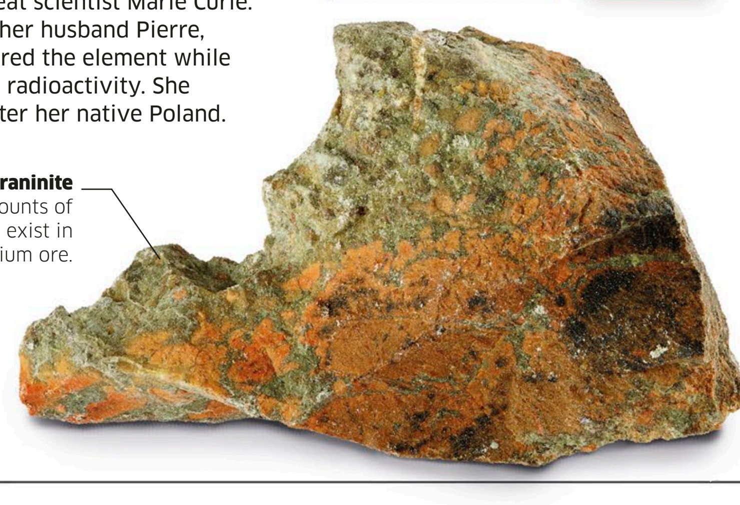
Brittle crystals
This laboratory sample of refined antimony is hard but easily shattered.

POLONIUM
Polonium
Discovered: 1898

This highly radioactive and toxic element will forever be associated with the great scientist Marie Curie. Along with her husband Pierre, she discovered the element while researching radioactivity. She named it after her native Poland.



84 (209)
Po
POLONIUM



Uraninite
Tiny amounts of polonium exist in this uranium ore.